

Yaxuan Liu

Peking University | Exchange Student at UC Berkeley, Fall 2026

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Research Interests

Economic History • Political Economy • Historical Sociology • Applied Microeconomic Theory

Education

Sep 2023–Present	B.A. in Philosophy, Politics & Economics (PPE) GPA: 3.788. Economics focus. <i>Graduate coursework:</i> Game Theory and Applications, Advanced Microeconomics, Advanced Macroeconomics. <i>Other coursework:</i> Econometrics, Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Software Design Practice.	<i>Peking University, Yuanpei College</i>
Sep 2024–Present	Yan Fu Class Program for the Development of Innovative Talent in the Social Sciences.	<i>Peking University, Division of Social Sciences</i>
Aug 2026–Dec 2026	Exchange Student in Economics	<i>University of California, Berkeley</i>

Independent Research

Oct 2025–Present	<i>From Land to Liquidity: Compensation Design and Local Population Reallocation in Taiwan's Land-to-the-Tiller Reform</i>	<i>School of Economics, Peking University</i>
	• Uses the compensation provisions of the 1953 Land-to-the-Tiller Reform Act and subsequent amendments to study whether making land wealth more liquid encouraged rural population outflows. The analysis draws on township-level population and land statistics published in government reports.	
Apr 2026–Present	Historical Research on Taiwan's Land Reform	<i>Department of Sociology, Peking University</i>
	• Advised by Professor Geng Tian. Examines institutional, intellectual, and legal continuities and ruptures through reports from the Central Political School's Graduate School of Land Economics, writings by Hsiao Cheng and other reformers, and legal-historical sources.	

Research Experience

Mar 2024–Present	Research Assistant to Professor Yiling Zhao	<i>School of Economics, Peking University</i>
	• Used batch OCR and natural-language processing to extract student descriptions from U.S. college yearbooks published from the 1900s through the 1930s; examined how coeducation changed the use of gendered language.	
Jun 2025–Present	Research Assistant to Professor Zenan Wu	<i>School of Economics, Peking University</i>
	• Worked on industrial organization models of platform markets, using analytical and numerical methods to study platform and seller behavior when consumers can observe product prices.	
Sep 2025–Oct 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Tianyang Xi	<i>National School of Development, Peking University</i>
	• Cross-checked biographical records of Chinese government officials against publicly available sources.	

Teaching & Academic Activities

Fall 2024, 2025	Teaching Assistant, Principles of Economics I	<i>School of Economics, Peking University</i>
	Led weekly discussion sections and office hours for first-year students; graded assignments and exams.	
Fall 2024	Co-Leader, PPE Reading Club	<i>Peking University</i>
	Organized seminars on “The Corporation and the Contract: Coase and Beyond”; led discussions of classic and recent work in contract theory and coordinated faculty guests.	

Leadership

Sep 2023–Jun 2024	Head, Cultural & Student Life Department	<i>Yuanpei College Student Union</i>
	Planned events for a student community of about 1,000 and managed the department’s weekly operations. Led the college team to first place in Group B at the university’s annual December Ninth choral festival.	

Honors & Awards

2025	Global Exploration Scholarship
2024	China Merchants Securities Scholarship • Award for Social Practice and Public Service
2023	Li Huirong Scholarship • Academic Excellence Award, Yuanpei College

Methods, Programming & Languages

Methods	Econometrics and causal inference; archival research; analytical and numerical modeling
Programming	Python, Stata, R, C++; OCR and natural-language processing; Git/GitHub
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native); English (advanced)